

HIBMAT UNIVERSITY INSTITUTE OF BUEA

GUIDELINES FOR PROJECT WRITING 2023

A) FORMATTING TEXT :

- i) **Margins:** Top 2.5; bottom: 2.5; Right: 2.5 and Left: 3.0
- ii) **Font type and size:** Times New Roman and font size : 14
- iii) **Line spacing:** 1.5
- iv) **Alignment:** Work must be justified
- v) **Paragraphing:** Use block style paragraphing all through
- vi) **Pagination:** Pages should appear at the upper right-hand of the page

B) OTHER DETAILS

- i) Minimum size = 40 pages
- ii) Submit new work alongside old work corrected
- iii) Type work and submit for correction in hard copy
- iv) Hard cover should be green
- v) Plagiarism will attract a score of 0.00%

C) PRELIMINARY PAGES

Inside Cover Page *(Similar to cover page and not numbered. It carries the title of the research, school and department, researcher and supervisor's names, a statement indicating what the research is a requirement for and at the bottom right, the month and year of submission. The format of this page can be gotten from the library)*

Declarationi *(This page is signed and dated by the student declaring that the work with the given title has been personally carried out by he or she and that other sources cited have been acknowledged through referencing)*

Certificationii *(The page shows the certification and approval of the project supervisor on the originality of the study, as a true work carried out by the student. It is signed and dated by the supervisor, the Head of Department and the Dean of the School)*

Dedicationiii *(The student dedicates the research to someone, dead or alive. Academic works are not dedicated to God)*

Acknowledgementsiv *(The student writes to appreciate all persons who contributed, (morally, financially, technically and in any other form) to the success of the research)*

Abstractv *(This page consists of a synopsis of the whole research work. It is usually written in the past continuous tense and is expected to summarize the statement of the problem, objectives of the study, the methodology, major findings, conclusion and recommendations.)*

Table of Contentvi (Main headings and sub-headings along with page numbers are listed in this section for easy page identification and reference. Preliminary pages are numbered in Roman numerals i.e. i, ii, iii etc, while other pages are numbered in Arabic numerals i.e. 1, 2, 3 etc.)

List of Tablesvii (Help the reader to easily identify tables in the work by numbering them well and explicitly.)

List of Figuresviii (Help the reader to easily identify figures in the work by numbering them well and explicitly.)

List of Abbreviations (if any).....ix

D) MAIN BODY OF RESEARCH

CHAPTER ONE: INTRODUCTION

- 1.1 Background to the Study** (Describe in general terms the larger area of the problem being investigated. This will serve as the basis of introducing the problem.)
- 1.2 Problem Statement** (Must indicate exactly what the problem is, why and how it is a problem to the organisation or industry under study. Give information to support this e.g. by use of statistics.)
- 1.3 Research Questions** (Must be based on the problem and breaks it into components to act as guides to the researcher in the quest to provide solutions to the problem being investigated. There should one general question in line with the title and then broken into specific questions in line with the components of the problem the candidate has hypothesized as variables to be investigated. Students for Bachelor's Degree at HUIB should consider a maximum of two independent/control variables and one dependent variable. Hence a maximum of two specific questions.)
- 1.4 Objectives of the Study** (Should be in line with the research questions such that when the questions are answered, the objectives of the study are achieved. Similarly, there should be one general objective adopted from the general question and specific variables have to be in line with the variables the candidates hypothesize to influence the phenomenon being investigated.)
- 1.5 Hypothesis** (They are tentative testable statements about the relationship between the variables to be proved right or wrong. Should be drawn from the specific objectives. There should be NO general hypothesis. Just the specific objectives and a maximum of two. Must be stated in the null form.)
- 1.6 Significance of the Study/Justification** (Indicate those that will benefit from findings of the study and how.)
- 1.7 Scope of the Study/Delimitations** (The scope should cover both the content scope, thematic, time and geographical scope.)

- 1.8 Organisation of Work** (*Highlight how the work progress chapter by chapter from start to end.*)
- 1.9 Operational definition of terms** (*State clearly the definitions of some variables, concepts, unfamiliar terms or technical terms related to the study that might be confusing to the reader.*)

CHAPTER TWO: LITERATURE REVIEW

- 2.1 Conceptual Literature** (*Review literature on key factors and concepts used in your work and relating to the variables considered by the study. Ensure to review all the variables involved. This section can end with a conceptual framework; a diagram showing the relationship between variables*)
- 2.2 Theoretical Literature** (*Relevant theories, models and frameworks relating to the problem being investigated in the study should be briefly discussed and linked to the study to provide the right framework for the study, i.e., theories on which the study is anchored. For each theory, highlight the author and year; state the theory, its contribution to the study and its limitations.*)
- 2.3 Empirical Literature** (*Review other empirical works such as scientific papers, journal articles and thesis similar to your topic to have an idea of the trend in results. State the author, year, topic, objective, methodology and results of the study. Also show how it agrees or disagrees with the expectation of your work. At least 5 empirical studies should be reviewed in chronological manner from the most recent to the least recent.*)
- 2.4 Research Gap** (*Identify the area missing in the existing literature that your research will cover. This could be in terms of time, concepts, or location of the research.*)

(FOR SCHOOL OF ENGINEERING)

CHAPTER THREE: METHODOLOGY

3.1 The study Area (*State where the study will be done (location) and why it was chosen*)

3.2 Study Technique or Method (*Depending on relevance of the study, your project can be based on any of following methods:*

- *Implementation*
- *Simulation*
- *Analysis*
- *Design*
- *Investigation*)

3.3 Limitations of Technique (*Indicate the limitations of the method chosen above as far as your research project is concerned.*)

CHAPTER FOUR: RESULTS

4.1 Presentation and Discussion of Results (*Discuss the results of the study carried out as in Chapter Three*)

4.2 Limitations of the project

CHAPTER FIVE: CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATION

5.1 Summary of major findings

5.2 Conclusion

5.3 Recommendation

REFERENCE

APPENDIX (*for code used in your implementation/simulation/design*)

(FOR SCHOOL OF BUSINESS)

CHAPTER THREE: METHODOLOGY

- 3.1 The study Area** *(State where the study will be done and why it was chosen)*
- 3.2 Research Design** *(It shows the particular research design being adopted for the study and why.)*
- 3.3 Data Collection** *(Explain how field or laboratory data collection will be done)*
 - 3.3.1 Sources and Types of Data** *(Indicate where the data was collected from and the type of data whether primary or secondary)*
 - 3.3.2 Data Collection Instrument** *(You should describe in detail all the instruments used in collecting the data for the project. These may include questionnaire, interview, schedules etc. The instrument should be explained including how it is patterned, sectioned and scaled in terms of expected responses and weightings.)*
 - 3.3.3 Reliability of Research Instruments** *(Explain the method of reliability, how it was done and the results obtained. There should be an explanation of the type of reliability that was undertaken and its justification.)*
 - 3.3.4 Validation of the Instruments** *(The processes involved in the validation of your instruments should be explained. This is mostly based on the face and content validity depending on the nature of your study.)*
 - 3.3.5 Limitations of the instruments** *(Indication the difficulties in using the instrument to collect data)*
- 3.4 Sample Design and Sampling Technique** *(The target population and the sample population for the study should be given. The sample refers to a section of the target population that was used for the study. Indicate your sample size. Also, the technique used in selecting the sample should be stated and you should give justification for the adoption of such technique as it relates to your study e.g. random, stratified, snowball, convenience sampling techniques etc. It must be adequate for generalization, hence, students should ensure that a scientific procedure is employed for selecting an appropriate sample size e.g. Taro Yamane formula, Yale formula etc.)*
- 3.5 Operationalization of Variables** *(Indicate the variables used in your research work, their type i.e. dependent, independent, control, extraneous, moderating variables etc. Describe their expected relationships. This can be done with the use of a table.)*
- 3.6 Method of Data Analysis** *(State the statistical tools used in the analysis such as percentages, frequency counts, mean, standard deviation, chi-square test, t-test, analysis of variance (ANOVA), bar charts, pie charts, etc. and justify the selection of such method, depending on the nature of your study.)*
- 3.7 Ethical Considerations** *(Outline the ethical issues considered during the research)*

CHAPTER FOUR: DATA PRESENTATION AND ANALYSIS

- 4.1 Characteristics of respondents** (*discuss the demographic characteristics of the respondents*)
- 4.2 Presentation and Discussion of Descriptive Results** (*Use descriptive statistical techniques such as frequencies, percentages, tables and charts to describe the opinions of respondents on the variables*)
 - 4.2.1 Variable 1** (*Present and discuss the responses relating to first independent variable*)
 - 4.2.2 Variable 2** (*Present and discuss the responses relating to second independent variable if any*)
 - 4.2.3 Variable 3** (*Present and discuss the responses relating to dependent variable*)
- 4.3 Presentation and Discussion of Inferential Results** (*Use inferential statistical techniques such as chi-square test, t-test, analysis of variance etc. to test the hypothesis*)
 - 4.3.1 Test of Hypothesis 1**
 - 4.3.2 Test of Hypothesis 2**

CHAPTER FIVE: SUMMARY OF FINDINGS, CONCLUSION AND RECOMMENDATIONS

- 5.1 Summary of major findings** (*A brief summary of major findings of the study should be stated in a concise manner that captures the contributions to knowledge on the subject.*)
- 5.2 Conclusion** (*Conclusions should be drawn from the findings and in line with the specific objectives. This should not be a repetition of the findings.*)
- 5.3 Recommendation** (*Recommendations should also be based on the conclusions or major findings.*)
- 5.4 Recommendations for Further Research** (*In this section, the student makes suggestions for further studies. Such suggestions could arise from the limitations of the study.*)

REFERENCE (*This shows a list of all the relevant journals, books and all sources of information consulted in the course of the study, either online or in print. The American Psychological Association (APA) style should be used.*)

APPENDIX (*These are the listings of supplementary/ additional materials that are not added to the body of the work. It includes summary of all research evidence, data from case study, list of parameters, presentation of additional models/charts and copies of questionnaire/interview questions.*)